

Construction

It has been a hard day of construction but I'm nearly there. Luckily *fabricate* works on the celestial brass I got from the metallurgist I hosted last week. Begrudgingly I owe him my respect. He is a true craftsman and a relationship I should cultivate, albeit quietly. I'm still having trouble sourcing an animation gem, unfortunately that is an arena where my former affiliation does me no favors. Maybe I should just learn to craft them myself. The runic inscription is going well, so far it's passed every diagnostic enchantment. I've had more trouble actually assembling the rings, the inter-body resonance is intense I'm finding myself having to put up a *wall of force* just to keep everything from vibrating while I work, but it stands upright... after a few rebuilds. I've sketched a little diagram of the apparatus: Five rings, surrounding a central faceted orb.

The materials continue to be a challenge. Once I had to completely reinscribe *Rust* because it kept lunging towards *Stone* (petty antagonism among materials is something they never bothered to teach at the Conservatory). *Earth* keeps softening whenever I look at it too hard. The *Ice* disc is behaving beautifully, though it keeps frosting over my calipers. No matter, celestial brass is quite resilient to temperature swings. Worst of all, the *Dust* plate simply will not cohere. I tried binding it with resin, with wax, with a low-grade stasis charm. All failures. The plate only stabilizes when the other four are already in motion, which is not only impractical but deeply annoying because no one will sell me a damned gem so I'm stuck spinning things *by hand*! Chauncy says he has a lead, but I might need to handle this personally. I know should quash that impulse but I admit it's been decades since I've felt this firey, I'm on the verge of true innovation. Would one little adventure to the city really hurt?